

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 13

By Atchley

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the Sevier County High School football team, TSSAA Division I, Class 5A state champion.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to specially honor and commend those successful high school teams that, through their magnificent exploits, bring honor to Tennessee and serve as exceptional ambassadors for this State; and

WHEREAS, the Sevier County High School football team achieved an extraordinary level of success during the 2024 season, winning the coveted Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Association (TSSAA) Division I, Class 5A State Football Championship; and

WHEREAS, the Sevier County Smoky Bears vanquished every opponent for an undefeated season on their way to the BlueCross Bowl championship game on December 6, 2024, at Finley Stadium in Chattanooga, where they beat Page High School in a hard-fought battle in the title matchup; and

WHEREAS, on their path to the championship game, the Smoky Bears defeated Knoxville Central 35-12, Powell 25-24, Knoxville West 24-17, Oak Ridge 45-34, and finally Page 27-20, to secure the right to hoist the iconic gold football trophy; and

WHEREAS, the victory saw Sevier County High School claim its second football state championship in school history, joining the team from 1999, to properly end the 100th year of Smoky Bears football with a perfect record of 15-0; and

WHEREAS, the 2024 Sevier County Smoky Bears enjoyed the services of an outstanding coaching staff led by Head Coach Todd Loveday, who instilled in these exceptional young men a commitment to excellence in all that they do and encouraged maximum effort on the football field; and

WHEREAS, state championships are achieved only through hard work, dedication, and the ability to work together as a team and excel with a cooperative spirit; the Smoky Bears exhibited each of these rare qualities during their championship season; and

WHEREAS, the football players of Sevier County High School epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved the highest level of success on the field while showing the highest degree of character both on and off the gridiron; they inspired their fellow students and united the entire community during their triumphant run through the 2024 season; and

WHEREAS, the dedication, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible a championship football season but also surely bode well for their success in every future endeavor; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the football players of Sevier County High School for serving as exemplars of the high quality of the youth of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the players, coaching staff, team support staff, administrators, cheerleaders, and fans of the Sevier County High School football team on winning the 2024 TSSAA Division I, Class 5A State Football Championship.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.